

Section B: Option 3 Environmental psychology			
Topic	Background	Key research	Application
Stressors in the environment (Biological)	Environmental stressors and their impact on our biological responses.	Black and Black (2007) Aircraft noise exposure and resident's stress and hypertension.	At least one strategy for managing environmental stress.
Biological rhythms (Biological)	Biological rhythms and the impact of their disruption on our behaviour.	Czeisler et al. (1982) Rotating shift work schedules that disrupt sleep are improved by applying circadian principles.	At least one strategy for reducing effects of jetlag or shift work.
Recycling and other conservation behaviours (Cognitive)	Conservation behaviours and the factors which influence the tendency to conserve or recycle.	Lord (1994) Motivating recycling behaviour: A quasi-experimental investigation of message and source strategies.	At least one technique used to increase recycling or other conservation behaviour.
Ergonomics – human factors (Cognitive)	Cognitive overload and the impact of observation in the workplace environment.	Drews and Doig (2013) Evaluation of a configural vital sign display for intensive care unit nurses.	At least one workplace design based on ergonomic research.
Psychological effects of built environment (Social)	The impact of the built environment and urban renewal on our wellbeing.	Ulrich (1984) View through a window may influence recovery from surgery.	At least one example of environmental design used to improve health/wellbeing.
Territory and personal space (Social)	Defensible space and personal space in the workplace.	Wells (2000) Office clutter or meaningful personal displays: The role of office personalization in employee and organisational well-being.	At least one office design strategy which affects defensible space.

For full references please see Appendix 5e.

Section B: Option 4 Sport and exercise psychology

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Topic	Background	Key research	Application
Arousal and anxiety (Biological)	Optimising arousal, controlling anxiety and measuring anxiety in sport.	Fazey and Hardy (1988) The inverted-U hypothesis: A catastrophe for sport psychology.	At least one technique for managing arousal and anxiety in sport.
Exercise and mental health (Biological)	Benefits of exercise to mental health.	Lewis et al. (2014) Mood changes following social dance sessions in people with Parkinson's Disease.	At least one exercise strategy to improve mental health.
Motivation (Cognitive)	Self-efficacy and sports confidence, including imagery and sports orientation.	Monroe-Chandler et al. (2008) Playing with confidence: the relationship between imagery use and self-confidence and self-efficacy in youth soccer players.	At least one strategy for motivating athletes.
Personality – human factors (Cognitive)	Personality, its measurement and its relationship to sport.	Kroll and Crenshaw (1970) Multivariate personality profile analysis of four athletic groups.	At least one strategy for using knowledge of personality to improve sports performance.
Performing with others (Social)	Teams, coaching and leadership.	Smith et al. (1979) Coach effectiveness training: a cognitive-behavioural approach to enhancing relationship skills in youth sports coaches.	At least one strategy for improving team performance.
Audience effects (Social)	How an audience can facilitate or inhibit sports performance; home advantage.	Zajonc et al. (1969) Social enhancement and impairment of performance in the cockroach.	At least one strategy for training and preparing for playing spectator sports.

For full references please see Appendix 5e.

2d. Prior learning, knowledge and progression

No prior knowledge of the subject is required. The specification builds on, but does not depend on, the knowledge, understanding and skills specified for GCSE Psychology.

It is recommended that learners have attained communication and literacy skills at a level equivalent to a GCSE in English at Grade C or above.

Throughout the course of study learners are encouraged to develop an awareness of the role of psychology in society and its applications to many situations.

The qualification is therefore suitable for learners intending to pursue any career in which an understanding of human behaviour is needed. The qualification is also suitable for any further study in social sciences, or as part of a course of general education.

There is an emphasis on research skills and enquiry in order to enable the learner to progress into higher levels of education. The specification therefore provides a suitable foundation for the study of psychology and/or related courses in Higher Education.

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